

SimpleComp User Manual

AudioForge SimpleComp v1.0.0

Compressor with threshold, ratio, attack, release, and auto makeup gain

Overview

SimpleComp provides transparent and musical compression with:

- **Threshold:** -60 dB to 0 dB (where compression starts)
 - **Ratio:** 1:1 to 20:1 (how much to compress)
 - **Attack:** 0.1 ms to 100 ms (how fast)
 - **Release:** 10 ms to 1000 ms (how fast to recover)
 - **Auto Makeup Gain:** Compensates for volume reduction
 - **Gain Reduction Meter:** Visual feedback
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Quick Start

Vocal Compression (Natural)

1. **Threshold:** -20 dB
2. **Ratio:** 3:1
3. **Attack:** 10 ms
4. **Release:** 100 ms
5. **Auto Makeup:** On

6. Result: Smooth, controlled vocals

Drum Bus Glue

1. **Threshold:** -15 dB
 2. **Ratio:** 4:1
 3. **Attack:** 30 ms
 4. **Release:** 150 ms
 5. Result: Punchy, glued-together drums
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Parameters

Threshold

Range: -60 dB to 0 dB

Description: Level above which compression kicks in

Settings:

- **-30 to -20 dB:** Gentle compression (vocals, mix bus)
 - **-20 to -10 dB:** Moderate compression (bass, guitars)
 - **-10 to 0 dB:** Heavy compression (limiting, parallel)
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Ratio

Range: 1:1 to 20:1

Description: Amount of gain reduction

Ratios:

- **2:1 to 3:1:** Gentle (vocals, mastering)
 - **4:1 to 6:1:** Moderate (bass, drums)
 - **8:1 to 20:1:** Heavy (limiting, special FX)
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Attack

Range: 0.1 ms to 100 ms

Description: How fast compressor responds

Settings:

- **Fast (0.1-5 ms):** Catches transients (drums, plucks)
 - **Medium (10-30 ms):** Balanced (vocals, guitars)
 - **Slow (50-100 ms):** Lets transients through (keeps punch)
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Release

Range: 10 ms to 1000 ms

Description: How fast gain returns to normal

Settings:

- **Fast (10-50 ms):** Responsive (vocals, fast material)
 - **Medium (100-300 ms):** Musical (most uses)
 - **Slow (500-1000 ms):** Smooth (mastering, pads)
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Use Cases

1. Vocal Leveling

Settings:

- Threshold: -18 dB
- Ratio: 3:1
- Attack: 5 ms
- Release: 80 ms

Result: Even vocal levels

2. Bass Control

Settings:

- Threshold: -15 dB
- Ratio: 5:1
- Attack: 1 ms
- Release: 100 ms

Result: Tight, controlled bass

3. Parallel Compression

Settings:

- Threshold: -25 dB
- Ratio: 8:1
- Attack: 0.1 ms
- Release: 50 ms
- Mix: 30-40% parallel

Result: Punch + dynamics

Tips

1. Watch Gain Reduction Meter

Aim for 3-6 dB GR for natural compression, 8-12 dB for aggressive.

2. Use Auto Makeup Gain

Keeps loudness consistent while adjusting settings.

3. Slower Attack = More Punch

Let transients through for punchier drums/bass.

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